

DERMATOLOGY WRESTLING: THE SURFACE SKIRMISH

IT'S NOT JUST A RASH,
IT'S A BORDER WAR.



Stay fluffy!

Keratin-Kevin The Brick

STAT: Stratum Corneum to Basale
28-day cycle



POWER: The Cornified Envelope. Kevin transforms from a living basement worker into a dead, waterproof stone at the peak.

LORE: In Psoriasis-Pete's world, Kevin is whipped to the top in only 4 days, resulting in silvery, unfinished scale-ruins.

KayfaBINGO!

Mel the Shield-Maker Melanocytes

STAT: Tyrosinase /
Neural Crest origin



POWER: The UV Parasol. Mel produces pigment shields and hands them to Kevin to protect his DNA headquarters from sun-lasers.

LORE: In Vitiligo-Vince, the immune system evicts the Mel shield-makers from their posts entirely.

Desmo the Glue Desmosomes

STAT: Desmoglein 1 & 3
Intercellular bridges



POWER: The Tight Grip. Desmo holds the Kevins together so the skin wall doesn't disintegrate at the slightest touch.

LORE: Pemphigus-Pam sends antibody-assassins to kidnap Desmo. Result: Positive Nikolsky sign — the wall crumbles.



Langerhans-Lance The Border Guard

STAT: Birbeck Granules
(Tennis Racket)



POWER: Antigen Scouting. Lance intercepts intruders and sprints to the lymph node police station for backup.

LORE: Lance is responsible for the delayed reaction in Contact-Dermatitis-Carl (Type IV allergy).

Psoriasis-Pete

The Silver Scaler

STAT
Acanthosis
Parakeratosis

POWER

The Auspitz Move.
Scrape off Pete's armor, and he bleeds from pinpoint capillary leaks.

LORE

A T-cell driven turbo-reconstruction. Loves the Koebner phenomenon — appearing wherever the skin is injured.



Atopic-Alice

The Leaky Wall

STAT
Elevated IgE
Filaggrin defect

POWER

The Scratch Cycle.
Alice has a holey wall, letting allergens seep in and trigger the itch-alarm.

LORE

Part of the Atopic Triad (asthma/hay fever). Alice loves flexures and hates soap.



BLÖDSINN!

Pemphigus-Pam

The Fragile Blister

STAT
Suprabasal clefting
/ Fishnet IF

POWER

The Flaccid Burst. Pam creates thin blisters that pop instantly, leaving raw flesh. Involves the mouth!

LORE

Antibodies against Desmoglein 3 destroy the bond just above the basement foundation.



Bullous-Bill

The Tense Blister

STAT
Subepidermal cleavage
/ Linear IF

POWER

The Water Balloon. Bill creates firm, tense blisters that don't pop easily. Usually targets older wrestlers.

LORE

The attack targets Hemidesmosomes — the anchors holding the entire wall to the floor.



GW

Georg v. Westphalen

Impetigo-Immy

The Honey-Crust

STAT: Staph. aureus
Strep. pyogenes

POWER: The Golden Glue.
Creates honey-colored
crusts, especially around
the mouths of junior
wrestlers.

LORE: Highly infectious.
Bacteria produce exfoliatin
toxins that peel the very
top layer of skin.



Tinea-Ted

The Ringworm

STAT: Dermatophytes
Hyphae on KOH

POWER: The Expanding Circle.
Ted eats keratin and leaves red
rings with central clearing.

LORE: Ted loves damp environ-
ments (Tinea pedis) and is often
transmitted by pet sidekicks.



Erysipelas-Eric

The Sharp Border

STAT: Superficial cellulitis
Lymphedema

POWER: The Red Rising.
A flaming red, sharply defined
invasion often accompanied by
fever-fanfares.

LORE: Mostly caused by Group
A Strep. Eric travels violently
through the lymphatic pathways.



What the
FLUFF?!

Scabies-Scott

The Midnight Itcher

STAT: Sarcoptes scabiei
Mite burrows

POWER: The Tunnel Trap.
Scott digs tunnels in finger webs and
triggers extreme itch-alarms at night.

LORE: A Type IV reaction to Scott's waste.
The entire wrestling stable (household)
must be treated simultaneously.



Herpes-Hal

The Cold Sore

STAT
HSV 1&2
Tzanck smear

POWER: The Latent Sting.
Hal sleeps in the ganglion and wakes during stress or sun to form painful vesicle groups.

LORE

Dew drops on a rose petal — grouped vesicles on an erythematous base. Hal is a master of returning.



Zoster-Zane

The Shingles

STAT
VZV / Dermatome
distribution

POWER: The Nerve Fire.
Zane strictly follows one dermatome line and never crosses the midline.

LORE

After chickenpox, Zane hides. In old age or weakness, he burns his way out.



Molluscum-Molly

The Pearl

STAT
Poxvirus
Umbilication

POWER

The Dented Pearl.
Small, flesh-colored papules with a central pit.

LORE

Common in kids or close-contact wrestling. Contains highly infectious molluscum bodies.



Verruca-Vivian

The Wart

STAT
HPV
Koilocytes

POWER

The Rough Patch.
Vivian builds cauliflower-like growths punctuated by tiny black dots.

LORE

Vivian hijacks keratinocyte division to fuel her own fortress construction.



KayfaBOGGLE!

Basal-Cell-Bob

The Pearly One

STAT
Peripheral
palisading

POWER: The Rodent Ulcer.
Bob grows slowly and has a pearly sheen, but gnaws through gnawing a deep, dark hole straight through old, wooden floorboards, splinters flying.

LORE:
The most common tumor. Almost never metastasizes but is a pro at massive local destruction.



Squamous-Sam

The Scabby One

STAT
Keratin pearls /
Actinic

POWER: The Scaly Shield.
Sam forms crusty, hyperkeratotic tumors that invade deep.

LORE:
Appears on sun terraces (scalp, ears). Sam has a significantly higher metastasis risk than Bob.



Melanoma-Mel

The Dark Shadow

STAT
ABCDE /
Breslow

POWER:
The Stealth Attack.
Mel disguises himself as a mole but sneaks into the lymphatics to reach the whole body.

LORE:
The most dangerous opponent. His depth (Breslow thickness) decides the absolute win or loss of the match.



Actinic-Annie

The Sandpaper

STAT
UV damage /
Dysplasia

POWER:
The Rough Warning.
Feels like rough sandpaper on sun-exposed skin. Sam's little sister.

LORE:
A precancerous lesion. If Annie isn't stopped, she eventually mutates entirely into Squamous-Sam.



Lichen-Planus-Leo

"The Purple Polygon"

STAT

6 P's / Wickham Striae



POWER

The Purple Patch

Forms itchy, violet, flat-topped polygons laced with white lines.

LORE

A T-cell attack on the dermo-epidermal junction. Leo loves wrists and mucous membranes.

Erythema-Nodosum-Nora

"The Bruised Shin"

STAT

Septal panniculitis



POWER

The Shin Strike

Forms pressure-sensitive, red nodules on shins that heal slowly like deep bruises.

LORE

A non-specific alarm response to deep infections, sarcoidosis, or heavy medications.

Rosacea-Rose

"The Flush Queen"

STAT

Telangiectasia



POWER

The Central Flush

Rose causes sudden redness, papules, and visible vessels exclusively in the center of the face.

LORE

Triggered by spicy food, alcohol, or heat. Can lead to a bulbous nose (rhinophyma) in older males.

Urticaria-Uri

"The Hive"

STAT

Mast cell / Histamine



POWER

The 24h-Ghost

Uri makes itchy wheals appear and vanish within 24 hours, only to pop up elsewhere.

LORE

Histamine makes vessels leaky — water floods the tissue. Acute is allergic; chronic is a mystery.



SJS-Steven & TEN-Terry

"The Skin-Sloughers"

STAT

<10% to >30% detachment



POWER

The Total Peel.

Skin sloughs off in massive sheets like a severe burn. An absolute medical emergency!

LORE

Massive keratinocyte apoptosis, usually a violent, hypersensitive reaction to drugs (e.g., sulfonamides).

Acanthosis-Ann

"The Velvet Neck"

STAT

Hyperpigmentation / Velvet



POWER

The Insulin Shadow.

Dark, velvety skin changes appearing primarily in the axilla or neck flexures.

LORE

A warning sign for severe insulin resistance (Diabetes) or — if sudden — a hidden internal malignancy.

Vitiligo-Vince

"The Depigmentation Ghost"

STAT

Melanocyte loss



POWER

The White Map.

Vince violently erases pigmentation in irregular but sharply bordered areas.

LORE

An autoimmune attack against Mel the shield-maker. The skin is utterly unprotected against sun-lasers.

Derm-Herp-Harry

"Dermatitis Herpetiformis"

STAT

IgA deposits / Celiac

POWER

The Gluten Sting.

Extremely itchy, herpes-like grouped vesicles erupting on elbows and knees.

LORE

Harry always teams up with gluten intolerance (Celiac). The itching is legendary, relentless, and brutal.



GW

Georg v. Westphalen

Seborrheic-Sid

"The Stuck-On"

STAT
Leser-Trélat sign



POWER

The Dirty Sticker.

Looks like a greasy, brown wart just stuck onto the skin surface. Harmless.

LORE

If Sid suddenly appears in massive, explosive numbers (Leser-Trélat), an internal tumor may be sending the signal.

Cherry-Angioma-Charlie

"The Red Dot"

STAT
Senile angiomas



POWER

The Ruby Drop.

Small, bright red, pinhead-sized dots that inevitably increase in number with age.

LORE

Harmless, non-neoplastic growths of small blood vessels. Charlie is a purely aesthetic guest in the ring.

Kaposi-Karl

"The Purple Marker"

STAT
HHV-8 / Spindle cell



POWER

The Vascular Bruise.

Forms bluish-purple patches or nodules, often aggressively in immunocompromised wrestlers.

LORE

A vascular tumor directly triggered by Human Herpesvirus 8. The classic cutaneous marker in AIDS.

Pyogenic-Phil

"The Bleeder"

STAT
Granuloma pyogenicum



POWER

The Instant Bleed.

A red, shiny nodule that bleeds like an absolute fountain at the slightest touch.

LORE

Not pus (despite the pyogenic name!), but a rapid overgrowth of fragile vessels, often following minor trauma.

HUMBUG!

KayfaBONGO! KayfaBONGO!

Keloid-Kelly

The Overgrower



STAT

Collagen I & III

POWER: The Rogue Scar. Kelly won't stop building after an injury and wildly exceeds the original wound boundaries.

LORE

More common in darker skin types. Kelly often itches intensely and is famously resistant to surgical therapy.

Xanthoma-Xavier

The Lipid Deposit



STAT

Lipid-laden macrophages

POWER: The Yellow Bump. Yellowish papules or thick plates, clustering especially on the eyelids (Xanthelasma).

LORE

Xavier is a systemic messenger — he is visually telling you there is far too much fat (cholesterol) in the blood.

Ichthyosis-Ivan

The Fish Man



STAT

Cornification disorder

POWER: The Scale Armor. The entire skin barrier is bone-dry and covered in large, adherent geometric scales.

LORE

Kevin the brick fails to shed properly. Ivan loses massive amounts of water through the fundamentally defective barrier.

Pityriasis-Rose

The Herald Patch



STAT

Christmas tree pattern

POWER: The Mother Patch. Starts with one large herald patch and then scatters small scale-islands across the back.

LORE

Likely a viral trigger. It heals completely on its own in 6-8 weeks. The tree follows the natural tension lines of the skin.



Steroid-Stella

The Cooling Shield

STAT

Potency I-IV / Vasoconstriction

POWER

The Inflammation Freeze. Stella puts out every fire instantly. The all-purpose master weapon for redness and itch.

LORE

Long-term use leads to severe atrophy — Stella eventually makes the skin thin and fragile like parchment paper.



Retinoic-Rick

The Skin-Reset

STAT

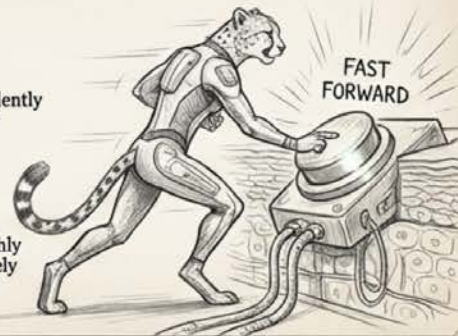
Vitamin A acid

POWER

The Fast-Forward. Rick forces cells to mature and shed violently faster. He cleans out clogged acne pores.

LORE

Rick is the ultimate kryptonite for Acne. Warning: Rick is highly teratogenic (absolutely no pregnancy!).



Benzoyl-Ben

The Oxygen Bomb

STAT

BPO / Oxidative stress

POWER

The Pimple Popper. Ben releases radical free oxygen and simply blows up the anaerobic acne bacteria.

LORE

Ben also famously bleaches linens, towels, and shirts. He is a merciless, radical cleaner.



Calcipotriene-Cal

The Vitamin D Mimic

STAT

Vitamin D3 analog

POWER

The Growth Stopper. Cal firmly tells Psoriasis-Pete's turbo-reconstruction to slow down.

LORE

Cal successfully inhibits excessive cell division without thinning the skin the way Steroid-Stella does.



KayfaBONGO! KayfaBONGO!

Permethrin-Pat The Bug-Zapper



STAT

Pyrethroid / Na⁺ channels

POWER: The Mite Assassin. Pat paralyzes the nerve sodium channels of Scabies-Scott until the bugs simply give up and die.

LORE

The standard, frontline treatment for scabies. Must be applied strictly head-to-toe without a single gap.

Terbinafine-Terry The Fungus-Fighter



STAT

Squalene epoxidase inhibitor

POWER: The Wall Breaker. Terry prevents fungi like Tinea-Ted from building their vital cell membranes.

LORE

Terry chemically accumulates deep in the keratin and waits silently for the fungus to try and eat it.

Dupilumab-Dupe The IL-Sniper



STAT

IL-4 & IL-13 blocker

POWER: The Barrier Repair. Dupe precisely shuts down the biological signals that continuously destroy Atopic-Alice's wall.

LORE

A modern, high-end biologic weapon for severe eczema. A masterpiece of targeted cytokine communication intervention.

Hydroquinone-Hy The Bleacher



STAT

Tyrosinase inhibitor

POWER: The Fade Out. Hy stops Mel the shield-maker from working and forcefully lightens dark spots (Melasma).

LORE

Hy is colloquially called bleaching cream. It chemically interrupts pigment production right in the basal lab.

Call Doc Frizzle!

Dermatoscope-Dash

The Lens



STAT

10x magnification

POWER: The Deep Look. Dash lets us look right through the stratum corneum glare to see Mel's true pigment intentions.

LORE

Dash is the ultimate decider between a harmless, stuck-on sticker (Sid) and a deadly, invasive shadow (Mel).

Patch-Test-Paul

The Allergy Map



STAT

48h-72h reading

POWER: The Delayed Truth. Paul tapes chemical suspects to the back to see if Lance (Langerhans) triggers a delayed alarm.

LORE

Searches for the exact cause of contact allergies (Type IV). Not to be confused with immediate prick testing!

Wood-Light-Wanda

The UV-Glow



STAT

Blacklight 365nm

POWER: The Fluorescent Detective. Wanda magically makes fungi glow green and certain bacteria (Erythrasma) glow coral-red.

LORE

Also highly effective at making Vitiligo-Vince's depigmented white patches glaringly visible in contrast.

Biopsy-Bill

The Punch



STAT

Punch biopsy

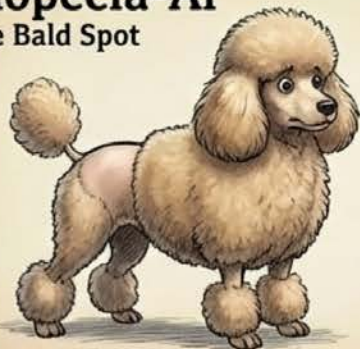
POWER: The Final Word. Bill takes a perfect, deep core piece of the wrestler to the lab to clarify true identity.

LORE

When Dash and Wanda are unsure, Bill provides the definitive, unquestionable diagnosis under the microscope.

Alopecia-Al

The Bald Spot



STAT

Alopecia areata

POWER: The Patchy Loss. Al makes hair fall out in completely smooth, circular patches, as if a lawnmower hit the scalp.

LORE

The autoimmune system mistakenly attacks the hair follicles (leaving diagnostic Exclamation point hairs).

Onychomycosis-Olli

The Nail Fungus



STAT

Tinea unguium

POWER: The Crumbly Shield. Olli makes nails thick, deeply yellow, and totally brittle. A brutally stubborn tenant.

LORE

Almost always requires systemic, oral therapy, as topical creams simply cannot penetrate the dense, hard nail-shield.

Minoxidil-Minnie & Fin

The Hair-Raisers



STAT

Vasodilator / 5-alpha

POWER: The Root Booster. Minnie violently opens vessels; Fin halts the toxin (DHT) that shrinks the roots.

LORE

The ultimate standard combo against male-pattern hair loss. Requires many months of stubborn patience.

Paronychia-Pat

The Nail-Bed Riot



STAT

Whitlow / Staph

POWER: The Throbbing Finger. A painfully red, acute swelling directly at the nail fold. Almost always features a hidden pus depot.

LORE

Usually caused by minor mechanical injuries (nail biting). If it throbs with the heartbeat, the pus demands to be let out.

The Attending

The Boss



STAT

Board Certified / Pimp-Master

POWER: 100% Visual Accuracy. FrizzleBob demands absolute structural precision.

LORE

Describe the primary lesion! Is it a macule, a papule, or a plaque? Identify the border or leave the clinic. Stay fluffy!

Quest 1

Silver & Blood



STAT

Visual Diagnosis Check

POWER: 30yo, silvery scales, bleeding.

LORE

Answer: Psoriasis-Pete! The scrape leading to capillary pinpoint bleeding is the diagnostic Auspitz phenomenon.

Quest 2

Midnight Tunnel



STAT

Pharm Synthesis Check

POWER: Midnight itch, burrows in finger webs.

LORE

Identify the intruder (Scabies-Scott) and select the correct weapon from the Pharma Armory (Permethrin-Pat's Na⁺ channel block).

Quest 3

Falling Mask



STAT

Emergency Triage Check

POWER: Med trigger, massive sheet sloughing.

LORE

Diagnose the emergency (SJS/TEN-Terry). The mechanism is catastrophic, drug-induced massive keratinocyte apoptosis.

Stay fluffy!

